

International Travel Policy

Document: TEP-013 **Version:** 1.5 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Finance Operations & Risk Management

1. Scope

This policy supplements the general Travel & Expense Policy framework with rules specific to international business travel — defined as travel between countries, including travel between the United States and Canada.

2. Approval

2.1. **All international travel** requires advance written approval from a Vice President (Grade 9) or above, in addition to the standard approval thresholds in TEP-001 §4.

2.2. Approval requests should be submitted at least 14 days prior to departure to allow time for travel risk review, visa requirements, and currency arrangements.

3. Travel risk

3.1. International travel to destinations classified as high-risk by Northwind's travel risk vendor (currently International SOS) requires additional security and Legal review.

3.2. Travel to countries under U.S. economic sanctions is prohibited absent an Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) license.

4. Lodging

4.1. International destinations not in Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3 of the Lodging Policy (TEP-004 §3) fall under Tier 4, where the rate cap is set at trip approval.

4.2. The approver should reference the U.S. Department of State's per-diem rates for the destination as a benchmark.

5. Per-diem for international travel

5.1. International per-diem rates are set at the U.S. Department of State M&IE rate for the destination city, at the time of trip approval.

5.2. International per-diem may be elected for trips of 3 or more nights, consistent with TEP-008.

6. Air travel

6.1. **Business class** is permitted on international segments of 10 hours or more with VP approval, per TEP-005 §2.3.

6.2. Premium economy is the default for international segments of 6 hours or more.

6.3. Stopovers added for personal reasons are at the employee's expense, with a comparison quote required at booking.

7. Currency and foreign transaction fees

7.1. **Currency conversion.** Expenses incurred in foreign currency should be reported in U.S. dollars at the exchange rate on the date of the transaction, using the rate posted by the Corporate Card issuer where applicable, or the OANDA daily rate otherwise.

7.2. **Foreign transaction fees** charged by the Corporate Card issuer are reimbursable as a separate line item, not bundled into the underlying expense.

7.3. **Cash advances** for international travel are permitted in limited amounts and require advance approval from Finance Operations.

8. Visas, immunizations, and passport fees

8.1. Visa fees, visa-application courier fees, and required immunizations for business travel are reimbursable at actual cost.

8.2. Passport application or renewal fees are not reimbursable unless the employee is required to obtain a passport solely for a specific business trip (e.g., previously did not need one and would not need one for future personal use). Such cases are rare and require VP approval.

9. Alcohol

The Alcohol Policy (TEP-003) applies to international travel with the modification noted in TEP-003 §6: where local law restricts alcohol, no alcohol is reimbursable regardless of business context.

10. Dependents

Travel costs for spouses, dependents, or other companions on international trips are never reimbursable, per the general rule in TEP-005 §6.

11. Definitions

- **International travel** — Travel involving a border crossing, including U.S.-Canada and U.S.-Mexico travel.
- **High-risk destination** — A country classified as elevated risk by the Company's contracted travel risk vendor (currently International SOS); see SEC-301.
- **OFAC license** — Authorization issued by the U.S. Office of Foreign Assets Control to engage in otherwise-prohibited transactions in sanctioned jurisdictions.
- **Stopover** — A scheduled break in an itinerary, typically more than 24 hours, not necessary for the routing itself.

12. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview
- TEP-004 Lodging Policy (Tier 4 international)
- TEP-005 Air Travel Policy (business class on long-haul)
- TEP-008 Per-Diem Rates (international per-diem)
- TEP-009 Employee Grades Reference (VP approval definition)
- SEC-301 Travel Risk and Security Protocol (mandatory companion document)

13. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2020-03-01	A. Singh	Initial publication
1.3	2022-07-20	A. Singh	Tightened high-risk destination approval
1.5	2025-01-01	J. Whitman	Annual review

Next scheduled review: 2026-01-01 **Document owner:** Finance Operations & Risk Management fin-ops@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** S. Chen, VP Finance; M. Ruiz, Chief Risk Officer

Distribution: All employees with international travel approval; available on intranet at intranet.northwindlogistics.com/policies/tep-013

Conference Attendance Policy

Document: TEP-014 **Version:** 1.3 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Learning & Development, in coordination with Finance Operations

1. Scope

This policy governs employee attendance at external conferences, training events, industry summits, and similar professional development activities involving travel or significant Company expense.

2. Eligibility and approval

2.1. Conference attendance must be pre-approved in writing by the employee's manager. Approval requests should include:

- The conference name, dates, and location
- Estimated total cost (registration + travel + lodging + meals)
- Business justification — how the conference relates to the employee's role, team objectives, or career development plan
- Names of any other Northwind employees attending the same conference

2.2. Where the total cost exceeds \$5,000, Director-level (Grade 7) approval is required. Where it exceeds \$10,000 or involves international travel, VP-level (Grade 9) approval is required, per TEP-001 §4.

3. Registration fees

3.1. Conference registration fees are reimbursable at the standard attendee rate.

3.2. Premium passes (VIP, all-access, executive tracks) are reimbursable only when they provide demonstrable business value not available at the standard rate (e.g., access to specific workshops critical to the employee's role).

3.3. **Early-bird registration** should be elected whenever the conference offers it and the trip is planned far enough in advance.

4. Travel and lodging

Travel and lodging to and from the conference are reimbursed under the general framework (TEP-004 Lodging, TEP-005 Air Travel, TEP-006 Ground Transportation).

5. Meals at conferences

5.1. **Meals included with registration.** Where the conference registration fee includes meals (most full-day conferences include lunch; many include breakfast and reception meals), no separate reimbursement is available for those meals. The employee should consume the included meals.

5.2. **Meals not included with registration** are reimbursed under the standard Meals and Entertainment Policy (TEP-002) per-meal caps.

5.3. **Off-site dinners with conference colleagues** are not automatically client entertainment. They are treated as solo or team-only meals (TEP-002 §2) unless attended by an external client or prospect.

6. Conference attendance with clients

6.1. Where an employee attends a conference together with a client (e.g., bringing a client to an industry event), the related entertainment is governed by the Meals and Entertainment Policy (TEP-002 §4) and may carry higher caps if VP approval is in place.

7. Extending trips

7.1. Employees may extend the trip for personal reasons (e.g., a weekend before or after the conference). The Company pays only for the business portion of the trip.

7.2. Compare-quote requirement: where extending the trip increases the airfare, the employee must provide a comparison quote at booking showing the cost for the business portion only, and the difference is the employee's responsibility.

8. Conference deliverables

8.1. Employees attending an approved conference are expected to share key takeaways with their team within 30 days of return. A short written summary (one page, or a presentation) is appropriate; the format is at the manager's discretion.

8.2. Conference materials, slides, and recordings provided by the conference may be shared internally consistent with the conference's attendee terms.

9. Non-attendance and cancellation

9.1. If an approved conference is cancelled or the employee can no longer attend, the employee should pursue refunds of registration and travel costs to the extent practicable.

9.2. Non-refundable costs from a cancelled conference are absorbed by the Company provided the cancellation was for a legitimate reason (manager decision, illness, business priority change).

10. Definitions

- **Conference** — A multi-session organized industry event involving travel or significant Company expense, typically including paid registration.
- **Conference deliverables** — A short written summary or presentation prepared by the attendee within 30 days of return.
- **Early-bird registration** — A registration tier offered at a discount for early commitment, typically 30-90 days before the event.

11. Related documents

- TEP-001 Travel & Expense Policy — Overview
- TEP-002 Meals and Entertainment Policy (meals not included with registration)
- TEP-004 Lodging Policy
- TEP-005 Air Travel Policy
- TEP-009 Employee Grades Reference (approval thresholds)
- LD-101 Learning and Development Framework (separate; managed by L&D)

12. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2021-01-15	L. Ahmed	Initial publication
1.2	2023-06-22	L. Ahmed	Added deliverables expectation
1.3	2025-01-01	L. Ahmed	Annual review

Next scheduled review: 2026-01-01 **Document owner:** Learning & Development, in coordination with Finance Operations learning@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** Chief People Officer; concurrence from VP Finance **Distribution:** All employees; available on intranet at intranet.northwindlogistics.com/policies/tep-014

Travel Risk and Security Protocol

Document: SEC-301 **Version:** 1.4 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Owner:** Risk Management
Applies To: All employees traveling internationally on Company business

1. Purpose

This protocol describes the risk assessment, preparation, and ongoing support that applies to international business travel. Its purpose is to protect the safety, security, and well-being of traveling employees and to enable the Company to fulfill its duty-of-care obligations.

2. Scope

This protocol applies to all international business travel — defined as travel involving a border crossing in connection with Company business. It does not modify reimbursement rules, which are governed by the International Travel Policy (TEP-013) and related travel & expense documents.

This protocol does not apply to domestic travel except where a specific destination has been identified as elevated risk.

3. Travel risk vendor

3.1. The Company contracts with International SOS for travel risk intelligence and 24/7 medical and security assistance. All international travelers are enrolled in International SOS automatically based on travel bookings made through Concur Travel.

3.2. The International SOS Member Number for Company travelers is available in the Travel Portal.

3.3. International SOS contact: +1-215-942-8226 (24/7).

4. Pre-travel risk review

4.1. Country risk classification is published by International SOS. The current Company-recognized tiers are:

Tier	Description	Action required
Low	Most of Western Europe, USA/Canada, Australia, NZ, Japan, Singapore	Standard travel booking
Medium	Most of Latin America, Eastern Europe, much of Asia	Standard booking + traveler briefing

Tier	Description	Action required
High	Designated countries with elevated security, health, or political risk	VP approval + Risk Management briefing
Extreme	Active conflict zones, sanctioned countries	Generally prohibited

4.2. Travel to High-tier destinations requires: - Vice President approval (Grade 9+) per TEP-013 §2 - A pre-travel risk briefing with Risk Management - Confirmation of International SOS enrollment - An itinerary submitted to Risk Management

4.3. Travel to Extreme-tier destinations is generally prohibited and requires CFO and General Counsel approval, with a documented business necessity that could not be addressed remotely.

5. Visas, immunizations, and documentation

5.1. Travelers are responsible for obtaining required visas. Visa fees are reimbursable under TEP-013 §8.

5.2. Immunizations recommended for the destination should be obtained well in advance of travel. The Company will reimburse for required immunizations.

5.3. A copy of the traveler's passport and itinerary should be left with a trusted contact at home.

6. In-country guidance

6.1. **Communication.** Travelers should maintain regular communication with their home office and family. International SOS may be used for routine status calls in elevated-risk destinations.

6.2. **Lodging.** Stay in vetted lodging — preferably international hotel chains with consistent security standards. Confirm the lodging is on the International SOS approved list for High-tier destinations.

6.3. **Local transportation.** Vetted ground transportation should be arranged in advance for airport transfers in High-tier destinations.

6.4. **Documents.** Carry the passport, secondary photo ID, and a copy of the visa. Keep these secure (hotel safe when not needed; document holder when needed).

6.5. **Health.** Follow standard precautions for food and water in the destination. Pack a basic first-aid kit. Identify the nearest International SOS-recommended medical facility.

7. Incidents

7.1. **Medical emergency.** Call local emergency services and notify International SOS, who can coordinate evacuation, second opinions, and home-office notification.

7.2. **Security incident** (loss, theft, harassment, civil unrest). Move to safe location and call International SOS for assistance.

7.3. **Detention or arrest.** Identify yourself, do not resist, and request to contact the U.S. Embassy (or relevant home-country embassy) and International SOS. Notify Risk Management as soon as possible.

7.4. **Death or serious injury.** Notify International SOS first, who will support family notification, repatriation, and Company coordination.

8. Information security while traveling

8.1. Follow the Mobile Device Acceptable Use Standard (SEC-204) for handling devices internationally, including the recommendation to use loaner devices in high-risk destinations.

8.2. Border searches of electronic devices are increasingly common. Travelers should assume that devices may be inspected and should not carry sensitive data on the device when crossing borders.

8.3. Use VPN for all internet access while abroad.

9. Sanctions compliance

9.1. Travel to countries under U.S. economic sanctions (currently: Cuba, Iran, North Korea, Syria, and certain regions of Ukraine and Russia) is prohibited absent an OFAC license. Travel approval requests for these destinations are routed to General Counsel.

9.2. Sanctions screening is part of the pre-travel review for borderline destinations.

10. Personal travel combined with business

10.1. Combining personal travel with a business trip is acceptable. Reimbursement is only for the business portion (TEP-005 §6.2, TEP-013 §6.3).

10.2. The risk and security protections in this document apply only to the business portion of the trip. International SOS coverage during the personal portion is at the traveler's election; many home insurance and credit card products provide travel medical coverage.

11. Returning travelers

11.1. After return from a High-tier destination, travelers should debrief with Risk Management within 5 business days. Debriefs help update the Company's risk understanding.

11.2. If symptoms of illness develop within 14 days of return from certain destinations (per CDC or WHO advisories), notify HR before returning to the office; remote work may be advisable.

12. Definitions

- **High-tier destination** — A country categorized as elevated risk per International SOS.
- **OFAC** — U.S. Office of Foreign Assets Control; administers economic sanctions programs.
- **International SOS** — The Company's contracted travel risk and medical assistance vendor.

13. Document control

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	2021-11-01	S. Larsen	Initial publication
1.3	2023-12-05	S. Larsen	Aligned with updated International SOS contract
1.4	2025-01-01	M. Ruiz	Annual review

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risk@northwindlogistics.com **Approver:** Chief Risk Officer **Related documents:** TEP-013

International Travel Policy, SEC-204 Mobile Device Acceptable Use, TEP-005 Air Travel Policy